- Divide the difference evenly to all seams and mark the difference with a dot on each part has to be changed.
- Draw the outline of the pattern through the dot, adapting to the original shape.
- Check that the new line is not too steep or curved – in that case it will not fit properly after sewing. In case of improper fit allowance reduced or added can be from/to the waist darts.
- Check that seams that will be sewn together still have the same length.

Note that the patterns of slim garments that are made of elastic fabrics can be slightly smaller than actual body measurements.

Altering the Width of a Pattern from Waist Darts

- Measure the waist of the pattern and individual waist.
- Compare the pattern measurements with your own measurements and calculate the difference.
- Add or reduce the difference to/from all waist darts so that one can add or reduce the same amount from the side of each dart and draw new lines towards the tip of the dart.
- Check that the sides of darts are the same length and that the edge of the pattern continues smoothly over the darts.

Note that the darts should not be too wide. The back darts closest to center back should be wider than the other back darts – the width should not be more than 3-4 cm. Front darts should not be wider than 2,5 cm.

If there are two back darts, the darts closer to side seam can be left unsewn; this gives the waist more fullness. In this case, draw the edge of the pattern smooth above the dart that you are not sewing.

8.17.4 Pattern Alteration for Centre Front and Centre Back

Points to be Considered

- Keep all fabric grain lines, the centre front, and the centre back on the fabrics straight of grain.
- Make adjustments carefully in order to preserve the garment's original style or design lines. Maintain ease allowance for comfort.
- Whenever possible, use adjustment lines already provided on a pattern. When you alter a pattern, make corresponding changes on all related pieces.

Full Bust (Large Cup Size)

Slash across the pattern along bust dart fold line to centre front. Slash across the pattern from waist to shoulder along waist dart fold line. Spread the desired amount at centre front and bust area. Do not spread at shoulder seam. Redraw seam lines and darts. (New darts will be larger than the original darts.)

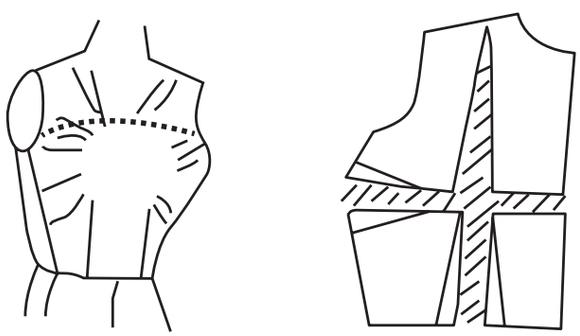


Figure 8.15 Pattern Alteration for Full Bust

Small Bust (Small Cup Size)

Slash across the pattern along bust dart fold line to centre front. Slash across

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